

INTO THE WILDERNESS

Written by

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FADE IN:

CREDITS:

EXT. WOODS - DAY

ESTABLISHING SHOT: of Schrammsteine mountain range.

CREDITS STOP.

EXT. CLIFF

BRENT (40s, survival backpack), solemn but broken, makes his way to the top of a cliff, a gorgeous look over what nature has to offer.

He plants the large BACKPACK on the ground.

Rummaging through the bag -- an URN.

Taped shut, he tries to cut it open, but struggles massively.

FRUSTRATED. These mundane problems, now unbearable under so much grief.

With his small POCKET KNIFE, he finally CUTS it open.

Holding the urn, he walks closer to the cliff.

DEEP BREATH.

UNSCREWS it.

He spreads the ASHES, which are carried away by the WIND.

He holds the urn underneath his arm, looks out.

BRENT

Like the first night we fell in
love... We're back...
You.-

DEEP, SHARP BREATHS.

BRENT (CONT'D)

You.- mean so much to me...

Brent's eyes start to water.

Another DEEP BREATH.

BRENT (CONT'D)
(chuckle out of feeling
lost and scared)
I don't know how I am gonna do this
without you...

Can't hold back the feeling of SORROW.
Wipes his eyes.

FADE TO BLACK.

FADE IN:

EXT. CLIFF - EVENING

Brent is seated at the cliff, cross-legged.
He doesn't want to leave.

But his body starts SHIVERING from the cold.

--

A STAKE gets HAMMERED in the GROUND.

INT. TENT - NIGHT

A large tent, urn in the corner of the tent.

Laying in his sleeping bag, Brent is looking at a **picture** of
him and his wife:

It's Brent (pale, unsportsmanlike-like, out of breath),
hunched over a sporty WIFE (36, healthy, dark-skinned),
smiling.

Brent is much improved physically and experienced in
surviving since the picture was taken.

Puts the picture in his breast pocket and turns off the
ELECTRIC LANTERN.

EXT. CLIFF - DAY/NIGHT

ESTABLISHING SHOT: NIGHT becomes DAY.

INT. TENT - DAY

Brent asleep.

LEAVES RUSTLING outside, Brent doesn't hear it.

A TWIG BREAKS.

Tired, he opens his eyes, locating the source of the noise.

The RUSTLING getting louder.

Now alarmed.

Brent starts crawling out the sleeping bag, trying to make as little noise possible, though the NYLON SLEEP SACK makes it impossible.

Sitting upright, Brent is circumnavigating where the noise is coming from.

LARGE FOOTSTEPS, CRUSHING LEAVES AND TWIGS UNDERNEATH -- clearly getting closer.

Brent tries to keep his worried BREATHING to a minimum, an especially difficult task now.

Whatever it is, it is so close that we can hear its large SNOUT, hovering over the floor right next to the tent.

Against all his senses, Brent reaches for the entrance zipper.

His arm, SHAKING, slowly getting closer, scared to make any noise.

He grabs hold of the METAL ZIPPER but from the other side -- a SNOUT pushes against the zipper.

Brent shoots his arm back.

GROWL.

No question -- that's a fucking BEAR.

Another GROWL, a louder one.
Does it know Brent is inside?
He doesn't want to find out.

He crawls as far away as his claustrophobic tent lets him, but he is still constricted in the sleeping bag from the waist down.

The bear is close enough that we can hear it's HEAVY BREATHING.

A CLAW, SLIDING over the TENT.

By this point, we can hear BRENT'S HEARTBEAT RACING.
His BREATHING grown more rapid too.

GROWL, louder than before.

It knows.

The bear circles to the other side of the tent, WALKING on the side of the TENT, making the already small tent, collapse in parts, adding to the claustrophobia.

The bear is heading to the corner Brent is hiding, Its shadow crawling over the tent towards Brent.

He CRAWLS away from the bear, to the entrance.

Opening the ZIPPER SLOWLY.

It takes Brent seconds of pulling the zipper down, which never stops making that sickening noise.

It's not even opened for a tenth of the way, or Brent feels he is already found out...

HEAVY BREATHING behind him, close to his ear, the bear's jaws right by Brent's head. It's breathing creates condensation on the POLYESTER TENT.

SLASH!

The BEAR LEAPS AGAINST THE TENT.

BRENT QUICKLY ZIPS THE TENT BACK UP AND FALLS BACK.

ROAR.

(ASPECT RATIO WIDENS)

Brent crawls in to the furthest corner.

BRENT'S POV: BLURRY, DIZZILY LOOKING AROUND.

It's quiet all of a sudden.

We can't even hear the leaves get crushed, or the heavy breathing anymore.

BLURRINESS STOPS.

Brent is tunnel visioned on the entrance side, BREATHING through his CHEST.

He holds his hands in front of his mouth, suppressing the BREATHING noise.

But there is no use -- the BEAR SLASHES at the ENTRANCE.

ROAR.

Brent picks up the urn, holds it as a weapon, or a shield.

Clueless, SWALLOWS deeply, SHAKING VIGOROUSLY.
He finds the courage -- ROARS BACK at the beast.

The bear ROARS, louder than before, and LOUDER than Brent can ever dream of.

It puts its FRONT PAWS on the tent, CRUSHING it under its immense wait.

The tent's AIR TUBES BREAK.

The entire tent COLLAPSES IN ON ITSELF.

Brent ROARS or YELLS, we can't tell through his angst.

The BEAR BURROWS it's teeth in the TENT -- RIPPING IT.

The monster PULLS the entire TENT to it's side -- STAKES GETTING PULLED FROM THE EARTH.

Brent, thrown to the side, urn escapes his grip and into the folds of the tent.
He is getting shaken around like beef jerky in a bag.

POLES BREAKING, the TENT getting RIPPED APART.

The Picture.

His Wife's face, flying back and forth through the tent.
Is this the last time Brent will see his wife?

Brent tries to crawl out of the nylon trap.

The tent has lost all its structural integrity.
There is no more space between the bear and Brent, just the paper thin polyester sheet on top of him.

ROAR.
We can hear the moisture from its GUMS.

The POCKET KNIFE!

Brent grabs it and tries to UNFOLD THE KNIFE.

The WET NOSE of the beast is looking for Brent in the folds of the tent.

The knife is unsheathed!

Brent CUTS through the TENT POLYESTER, like how he cut open the urn in the start.

He CRAWLS OUT -- but the BEAR is on his heels.

EXT. CLIFF - CONTINUES

He crawls out of the collapsed tent, like a baby being born.

Gets up on his two feet -- and ROARS, the bravest Brent can muster.

Turns around to the bear.

His eyes dart around the camp site, breathing heavy from his chest, still shaking.

There is no bear.

There never was.

(ASPECT RATIO BACK TO NATIVE)

After his breathing calmed down, Brent inspects the tent:

- No cuts.
- No tears.
- Air tubes in peak condition.

Just the cut he made himself.

Brent can't believe it.

Was there never a bear?

EXT. WOODS - DAY

Brent, backpack on, makes his way out of the dense woods.

He looks back to the woods -- he survived it.

Nods to himself, more determination in his look than before, looks at ground, back at the woods once more.

Turns away and leaves the forest behind him one last time.

CUT TO BLACK.

THE END